

THAT DEEPER FEELING

Conscious Intimacy Coaching

Your SPINE Self-Map

A curious person's guide to their own territory

How this works

These questions are designed to make you think. Some will feel obvious. Some might make you squirm a little. Good. That squirm is information.

Rate each statement honestly — not where you want to be, not where you think you should be. Where you actually are, right now.

- 1 · Barely ever
- 2 · Occasionally
- 3 · Sometimes
- 4 · Pretty often
- 5 · Almost always

After each section: one more question. That one question changes how everything gets read. Don't skip it.

S

Sovereignty

*Your inner territory — the parts of you that belong to you**Interior Ownership*

1. My thoughts feel like they belong to me.

1 2 3 4 5

2. I can have a feeling without immediately evaluating whether it's acceptable.

1 2 3 4 5

3. I can sit with an idea that contradicts what I was taught without panic.

1 2 3 4 5

4. I trust my own internal responses as valid data.

1 2 3 4 5

5. I don't need someone else to confirm what I'm experiencing before I believe it.

1 2 3 4 5

When I think about owning my inner life completely, my body responds with:

- Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Shame Jurisdiction

6. When shame arrives, I can usually tell whether it's mine or installed.

1 2 3 4 5

7. I can feel shame without it defining me.

1 2 3 4 5

8. I can trace most of my shame responses back to a specific origin.

1 2 3 4 5

9. I no longer automatically believe that shame means I've done something wrong.

1 2 3 4 5

10. I can distinguish between guilt I've earned and shame I was given.

1 2 3 4 5

When I imagine returning shame to its source, my body responds with:

- ☐ Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- ☐ Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- ☐ Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- ☐ Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- ☐ Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- ☐ Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Boundary Recognition

11. I can tell the difference between my feelings and someone else's expectations.

1 2 3 4 5

12. I know when I'm doing something because I want to versus because I should.

1 2 3 4 5

13. I can feel where I end and another person begins in a conversation.

1 2 3 4 5

14. I notice when someone is projecting their needs onto me.

1 2 3 4 5

15. I can hold my own perspective even when someone I respect disagrees.

1 2 3 4 5

When I hold my own boundary clearly, my body responds with:

- ☐ Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized

- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Doubt Permission

16. I can hold a question without needing to resolve it immediately.

1 2 3 4 5

17. Uncertainty doesn't feel like a moral failure to me.

1 2 3 4 5

18. I can say 'I don't know' without it feeling dangerous.

1 2 3 4 5

19. I'm comfortable with the idea that I might change my mind about important things.

1 2 3 4 5

20. I can explore a new idea without deciding whether it's right or wrong first.

1 2 3 4 5

When I let myself not know something important, my body responds with:

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Body check — Sovereignty

After sitting with these questions about your inner territory, what is your body doing right now?

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it

- Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

P

Power

Your capacity to act, speak, choose, and refuse from your own center

Self-Authorization

1. I give myself permission for things without waiting for someone else to approve.

1 2 3 4 5

2. I can make a decision without checking if it's okay with everyone first.

1 2 3 4 5

3. I act on my own judgment even when it might displease someone.

1 2 3 4 5

4. I don't need external validation to feel confident in a choice.

1 2 3 4 5

5. I can start something new without asking whether I'm allowed to.

1 2 3 4 5

When I imagine giving myself full permission, my body responds with:

- Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Voice Activation

6. I speak up when something matters to me, even if my voice shakes.

1 2 3 4 5

7. I can say what I actually think in a group without rehearsing first.

1 2 3 4 5

8. My voice feels like it belongs to me when I use it.

1 2 3 4 5

9. I can express disagreement without feeling like I'm being destructive.

1 2 3 4 5

10. I say the true thing more often than the safe thing.

1 2 3 4 5

When I imagine speaking my full truth, my body responds with:

- ☐ Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- ☐ Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- ☐ Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- ☐ Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- ☐ Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- ☐ Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Choice Ownership

11. I feel like the author of my own daily choices.

1 2 3 4 5

12. I can own a decision without immediately defending it.

1 2 3 4 5

13. I choose things for myself rather than defaulting to what's expected.

1 2 3 4 5

14. I take responsibility for my choices without excessive guilt.

1 2 3 4 5

15. I can choose something that only benefits me without feeling selfish.

1 2 3 4 5

When I own a choice that might displease someone, my body responds with:

- ☐ Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized

- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Refusal Capacity

16. I can say no to something I don't want without extensive justification.

1 2 3 4 5

17. My body gives me clear signals when something isn't right for me.

1 2 3 4 5

18. I can decline an invitation or request without guilt taking over.

1 2 3 4 5

19. I trust my no as much as I trust my yes.

1 2 3 4 5

20. I can refuse something even when the other person will be disappointed.

1 2 3 4 5

When I imagine saying no to someone I care about, my body responds with:

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Body check — Power

After exploring your relationship to power, voice, and choice, what is your body doing right now?

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it

- Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

I

Identity

*Who you are when no one is telling you who to be**Self-Authorship*

1. I have a clear sense of who I am apart from what I was taught to be.

1 2 3 4 5

2. My values feel chosen rather than inherited.

1 2 3 4 5

3. I can describe myself without referencing what I used to believe.

1 2 3 4 5

4. I'm building an identity that feels genuinely mine.

1 2 3 4 5

5. I know what I stand for, even if it's different from what I was raised with.

1 2 3 4 5

When I imagine being fully self-defined, my body responds with:

- Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Authentic Differentiation

6. I can be close to someone without losing myself.

1 2 3 4 5

7. I can love someone whose beliefs are different from mine without it threatening my identity.

1 2 3 4 5

8. I know the difference between being influenced and being controlled.

1 2 3 4 5

9. I can be part of a group without performing agreement I don't feel.

1 2 3 4 5

10. My closest relationships allow me to be fully myself.

1 2 3 4 5

When I hold my own perspective against pressure, my body responds with:

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Complexity Tolerance

11. I can hold two contradictory ideas without needing to resolve them immediately.

1 2 3 4 5

12. I'm comfortable with people who are different from me.

1 2 3 4 5

13. I don't need things to be all good or all bad to understand them.

1 2 3 4 5

14. I can appreciate something about a system I ultimately left.

1 2 3 4 5

15. I can sit with ambiguity without it feeling like a crisis.

1 2 3 4 5

When I sit with genuine ambiguity, my body responds with:

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized

- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Evolutionary Relationship

16. I see my past self with compassion rather than contempt.

1 2 3 4 5

17. I can integrate parts of my history without being defined by them.

1 2 3 4 5

18. I'm curious about who I'm becoming rather than anxious about it.

1 2 3 4 5

19. I allow myself to change without feeling like I'm betraying who I was.

1 2 3 4 5

20. My sense of self feels like it's growing rather than fracturing.

1 2 3 4 5

When I allow myself to be different from who I was, my body responds with:

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Body check — Identity

After looking at who you are apart from the system, what is your body doing right now?

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it

- Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

N Nourishment

What you need, want, and are allowed to enjoy

Desire Recognition

1. I can name what I want without immediately evaluating whether I should want it.

1 2 3 4 5

2. I notice my desires as they arise rather than after I've already suppressed them.

1 2 3 4 5

3. I can distinguish between what I genuinely want and what I think I should want.

1 2 3 4 5

4. My wants feel like valid information about who I am.

1 2 3 4 5

5. I can sit with a desire without acting on it or killing it — just letting it be.

1 2 3 4 5

When I let a desire exist without evaluating it, my body responds with:

- ☐ Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- ☐ Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- ☐ Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- ☐ Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- ☐ Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- ☐ Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Pleasure Capacity

6. I can experience physical pleasure without guilt arriving immediately after.

1 2 3 4 5

7. My body knows how to relax into something that feels good.

1 2 3 4 5

8. I can stay present during a pleasurable experience without dissociating or numbing.

1 2 3 4 5

9. I give myself permission to enjoy things that have no productive purpose.

1 2 3 4 5

10. Pleasure feels safe to me most of the time.

1 2 3 4 5

When I let myself enjoy something fully, my body responds with:

- ☐ Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- ☐ Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- ☐ Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- ☐ Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- ☐ Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- ☐ Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Need Legitimacy

11. I believe my needs are valid even when they're inconvenient for others.

1 2 3 4 5

12. I can ask for what I need without feeling like I'm being too much.

1 2 3 4 5

13. I don't minimize my own needs to make other people more comfortable.

1 2 3 4 5

14. I can receive care without feeling like I have to earn it first.

1 2 3 4 5

15. I trust that needing things is a normal part of being human, not a weakness.

1 2 3 4 5

When I ask for something I need, my body responds with:

- ☐ Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized

- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Erotic Reclamation

16. I can think about my own sexuality without shame taking over.

1 2 3 4 5

17. My erotic life feels like it belongs to me.

1 2 3 4 5

18. I can explore what turns me on without judging myself for it.

1 2 3 4 5

19. I can be sexually present — with myself or a partner — without leaving my body.

1 2 3 4 5

20. My sexuality feels like a natural part of who I am rather than something to manage.

1 2 3 4 5

When I think about my sexuality as mine, my body responds with:

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Body check — Nourishment

After sitting with questions about desire, pleasure, and need, what is your body doing right now?

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it

- Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

E

Embodiment

*Your relationship with the body you actually live in**Somatic Presence*

1. I can feel my body from the inside — not just see it from the outside.

1 2 3 4 5

2. I notice physical sensations as they happen rather than hours later.

1 2 3 4 5

3. I can stay present in my body during an emotional conversation.

1 2 3 4 5

4. My body feels like a place I live rather than a thing I operate.

1 2 3 4 5

5. I trust the information my body gives me.

1 2 3 4 5

When I try to feel my body from the inside, my body responds with:

- Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Body Trust

6. I trust my body's signals about what it needs.

1 2 3 4 5

7. I can feel hunger, tiredness, or discomfort without overriding it.

1 2 3 4 5

8. My body feels like an ally rather than an obstacle.

1 2 3 4 5

9. I don't manage my body as if it's something that might betray me.

1 2 3 4 5

10. I listen to my body before I listen to the rules about my body.

1 2 3 4 5

When I trust my body completely, my body responds with:

- ☐ Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- ☐ Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- ☐ Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- ☐ Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- ☐ Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- ☐ Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Pleasure Residency

11. I can feel pleasure in my body without immediately analyzing it.

1 2 3 4 5

12. My body remembers how to feel good, even if it took time to get here.

1 2 3 4 5

13. I can be touched (by myself or others) without bracing.

1 2 3 4 5

14. Physical warmth, softness, and comfort feel safe to receive.

1 2 3 4 5

15. I can stay in my body when it starts to feel something good.

1 2 3 4 5

When pleasure arrives in my body, my body responds with:

- ☐ Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized

- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Integrated Knowing

16. My body and my mind usually agree about what's true.

1 2 3 4 5

17. I can make decisions using gut feeling alongside logic.

1 2 3 4 5

18. When I check in with my body, I get useful information.

1 2 3 4 5

19. I trust my body's 'yes' and 'no' as much as my rational assessment.

1 2 3 4 5

20. My physical responses and my conscious thoughts are starting to align.

1 2 3 4 5

When my body says something different from my mind, my body responds with:

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it
- o Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- o Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- o Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- o Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

Body check — Embodiment

After exploring your relationship with your own body, what is your body doing right now?

- o Curiosity — open, interested, maybe a little energized
- o Mild resistance — some tightening, but I can stay with it

- Resistance — wanting to move away, close the document, do something else
- Significant resistance — tension, constriction, bracing
- Distress — flooding, rapid heartbeat, wanting to shut down
- Blankness — nothing, numbness, an absence of response

The Shame Source Locator

Last section. Worth sitting with.

These are the places where shame doesn't announce itself — it just arrives faster than you can notice it.

Somewhere in the body, right now, something may have already responded to the word “shame” before you even read the next sentence.

That response is the beginning of the map.

For each source below, rate how much shame your body carries — not how much you think you should feel, but how much actually arrives.

1 • Almost none 2 • A little 3 • Moderate 4 • Significant 5 • Overwhelming

1. Having desire at all

1 2 3 4 5

2. Specific desires or fantasies

1 2 3 4 5

3. My sexual history

1 2 3 4 5

4. My body's appearance or physical responses

1 2 3 4 5

5. My orientation or attractions

1 2 3 4 5

6. Having strong emotions

1 2 3 4 5

7. Doubting or leaving the system

1 2 3 4 5

8. Choices I made inside the system

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

9. How much I need from other people

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

10. Speaking up or using my voice

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

After sitting with these shame sources, notice your body. What is it doing right now? Where is the sensation strongest?

You're done.

Take a breath. A real one — not performative, not strategic. Just a breath because you just looked at some territory that most people spend their whole lives carefully not looking at.

Whatever you found in there — the high scores, the low ones, the places that made you squirm, the places that surprised you with how much they've healed — all of it is information. None of it is verdict.

This map doesn't tell you what's wrong with you. It shows you where you are. And where you are is the only place the work can begin.

Your report will translate these numbers into something you can actually use — a shape, a story, a set of practices chosen specifically for your landscape.

Until then: be gentle with yourself today. You just did something brave.

Your body held all of that. Thank it.